

OAS-028 — Simplicity Architecture

Status: Foundational

Authority: Architectural

Depends on:

- OAS-000 through OAS-027
 - OCS-000 through OCS-032
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Purpose

This specification defines the architectural role of Simplicity.

Simplicity is not the absence of complexity.

Simplicity is the architectural consequence of organizing complexity around constitutional necessity.

Architecture SHALL reduce accidental complexity.

Architecture SHALL preserve essential complexity.

The purpose of Simplicity is not minimalism.

The purpose is clarity without loss of meaning.

1. Architectural Objective

The objective of Simplicity Architecture is to ensure that constitutional understanding becomes easier to preserve, explain, and extend as the discipline evolves.

Architecture SHALL minimize:

Accidental complexity.

Hidden dependencies.

Unnecessary abstraction.

Redundant structures.

Architecture SHALL preserve every constitutionally necessary distinction.

2. Definition

Architectural Simplicity is the state in which every architectural element exists because constitutional necessity requires it.

Nothing essential is missing.

Nothing unnecessary remains.

3. Simplicity Independence

Simplicity SHALL remain independent of:

Implementation size.

Lines of code.

Performance optimizations.

Programming paradigms.

Commercial constraints.

Architecture SHALL evaluate necessity.

Not appearance.

4. Essential Complexity

Certain constitutional complexity is irreducible.

Architecture SHALL preserve complexity arising from:

Reality.

History.

Relationships.

Perspective diversity.

Constitutional continuity.

Irreducible complexity SHALL remain visible.

5. Accidental Complexity

Architecture SHALL continuously identify and reduce accidental complexity.

Examples include:

Hidden coupling.

Duplicate meaning.

Redundant abstractions.

Implementation leakage.

Historical inconsistency.

Reduction SHALL preserve constitutional behavior.

6. Simplicity Through Composition

Architecture SHOULD achieve simplicity through composition rather than elimination.

Small coherent architectural patterns SHALL compose into larger coherent systems.

Composition SHALL remain explainable.

7. Simplicity and Evolution

Architectural evolution SHOULD reduce accidental complexity over time.

Growth SHALL increase understanding.

Growth SHALL NOT require proportional increases in architectural confusion.

8. Simplicity Verification

Verification SHALL evaluate:

Necessity of every architectural responsibility.

Clarity of boundaries.

Coherence of composition.

Reduction of accidental complexity.

Preservation of constitutional meaning.

9. Simplicity Pattern

Architecture SHALL organize around constitutional necessity rather than implementation convenience.

Convenience changes.

Necessity endures.

Architecture SHALL preserve necessity.

10. Simplicity Architecture Test

Simplicity Architecture satisfies this specification when an independent architect can explain why every architectural element exists, what constitutional purpose it serves, and what constitutional property would be lost if it were removed.

If no constitutional purpose exists,

the architectural element SHOULD be reconsidered.

Conformance

An implementation conforms to this specification when architectural simplicity emerges through constitutional necessity while preserving meaning, continuity, reconstructability, and future evolution independently of implementation technology.

Architectural Principle

Simple architecture is not architecture with fewer parts.

It is architecture in which every part has earned the right to exist.

The highest form of simplicity is therefore not reduction,

but necessity made visible.

Architecture reaches maturity when nothing remains that can be removed without diminishing understanding,

and nothing remains hidden that should be understood.

End of Specification OAS-028